Topic 12 — Home Rule (होम रूल) & Labour Politics

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

Morley–Minto Reforms (context) | Lucknow (लखनऊ) Pact (लखनऊ पैक्ट) | Home Rule Movement | National Education | BHU Movement | Labour Movement | Left Parties | Regional Parties | Annie Besant (बेसेंट) | B.G. Tilak (तिलक) | AITUC (एटक) | Congress (कांग्रेस) Socialist Party

Sources baked in: Spectrum, Bipan Chandra, NCERT Themes III, Ghatnachakra Purvalokan (Morley–Minto / Lucknow Pact / Home Rule; Trade Union and Communist Party), UPPCS Prelims 2018–2025 **Weight:** ★★★ — two Home Rule leagues, Besant/Tilak, CSP year traps, Justice Party, WPP, AITUC map, BHU **Last verified:** September 2026 gap audit — Home Rule + Lucknow Pact CCR filled; Extra Drill present (no invented mega banks) **Current Affairs:** N/A (historical; skip NEP 2020)

12.0 Morley–Minto Reforms (1909) — bridge into Home Rule politics

Official name:Indian Councils Act, 1909 | Viceroy (वायसराय):Lord Minto II | Secretary of State:John Morley

- Full Act teaching lives in **Topic 3**. Hold only the bridge facts here.
- The biggest long-term feature is **communal representation**: **Muslim separate electorates** (Muslim voters elect Muslim members).
- It did **not** create **dyarchy** (द्वैध शासन), federation, or provincial autonomy — those traps belong to later Acts.
- **Rajendra Prasad** called **Minto** the **Father of Pakistan** for this communal seed.
- Gandhi's remembered verdict is that the Morley–Minto package **destroyed** Indian unity politics.
- **1909 creates** separate electorates; **1916 Lucknow Pact** is when **Congress accepts** them as a temporary bargain with the League.

Logic: 1909 = Act / separate electorates. 1916 = Congress acceptance in Lucknow Pact. 1919 = dyarchy.

12.1 Home Rule Movement

Demand: self-government for India **within the British Empire** (Irish Home Rule model) **Years: 1916–18** (peak); wartime politics after Tilak's return and Besant's press campaign

Causes

- World War I made Britain need Indian men and money; nationalists said pay, then give **self-government**.

- After Surat's long split, Extremists needed a **constitutional** mass programme short of later Gandhian satyagraha.
- Besant had floated the Home Rule idea in ***Commonweal*** from **1914**; Tilak's return from Mandalay gave Maharashtra a ready organiser.

Course

- Two leagues, **not one**. They **cooperated** but **did not permanently merge** in 1916–18.

Feature	Tilak's Indian Home Rule League	Besant's All India Home Rule League
Founded	**April 1916**	**September 1916**
HQ	**Poona**	**Madras / Adyar**
Early meeting	Belgaum	Madras base
Office	**Joseph Baptista** President; **N.C. Kelkar** Secretary	Besant; **George Arundale**, **B.P. Wadia**, S. Subramania Iyer
Area	Maharashtra **except Bombay city**, Karnataka, CP, Berar	Rest of India **including Bombay city**

- Papers: Tilak's ***Kesari*** and ***Mahratta***; Besant's ***Commonweal*** and ***New India***.
- Home Rule meant **responsible government under the Empire** (like the white Dominions), with religious freedom, national education and social–political reform on the programme.
- Lucknow **1916** was the show of strength for both leagues (Tilak's supporters even ran a special train often nicknamed the Home Rule / Congress Special).
- On **16 June 1917**, Besant, Arundale and Wadia were interned; protest made Home Rule a mass slogan; they were released in September.
- In **December 1917**, Besant became the **first woman President** of Congress, at Calcutta.

Results

- Pressure from Home Rule and the Lucknow joint demand helped produce the **Montagu Declaration (20 August 1917)** — a statement of intent for responsible government.
- The movement declined after Montagu–Chelmsford hope, Tilak's time abroad, and Gandhi's mass methods.
- In **1920** Gandhi was elected president of the All-India Home Rule League and renamed it **Swarajya Sabha**.
- Among Home Rule, Khilafat, Jallianwala and Moplah, Home Rule (**1916**) is earliest; Moplah (**1921**) is last.
- The **Lucknow Pact** and the **Montagu Declaration** belong to this same wartime season. Each has its own full teaching card next.

> **Logic:** Tilak = **April 1916 Poona Baptista**. Besant = **September 1916 Madras**. Two leagues. Bombay **city** is Besant's zone.

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q47)**: Chronology sequence — Home Rule Movement (1916) → Rowlatt / Jallianwala / Khilafat (1919) → Non-Cooperation (1920) → Moplah Rebellion (1921).

12.2 Lucknow Pact (December 1916)

Where: Lucknow session of Congress, presided by **Ambika Charan (चारण) Majumdar Parties: Indian National Congress** and the **All India Muslim League**

Causes

- Moderates and Extremists needed reunion after the long **Surat (1907)** break if Congress was to speak with one wartime voice.
- The League wanted security for Muslim representation; Congress wanted a joint reform demand while Britain was at war.
- Tilak and Besant's Home Rule energy made a Congress–League bargain politically useful in **1916**.

Course

- At the same Lucknow session, Moderates and Extremists **reunited**, and Congress and the League worked out joint political demands for the first time.
- The League kept **separate electorates**; Congress **accepted** them as a temporary bargain (the system itself began in **1909**).
- The two bodies agreed on **weightage**: Muslims got representation above their population (जनसंख्या) share in provinces where they were a minority (such as the UP and Bihar belt), and correspondingly less than their share in provinces where they were a majority (such as Punjab and Bengal).
- Both bodies jointly demanded **self-government**, an expansion of legislative councils, and a larger elected element in government.
- **Tilak** (तिलक) and **Jinnah** are the chief architects of the Congress–League bargain; **Besant** and **Tilak** pushed the **Extremist reunion** inside Congress.
- **Sarojini Naidu** called Jinnah the **Ambassador of Hindu–Muslim Unity** for this season.
- At the same Lucknow session, **Raj Kumar Shukla** first briefed Gandhi on the **Champaran** (चंपारण) indigo (नील) peasants' distress.

Results

- The joint demand fed directly into the pressure that produced the **Montagu Declaration** less than a year later.
- The Pact is Congress's **only** major formal seat-sharing deal with the League until the failed Cabinet Mission (कैबिनेट मिशन) talks of 1946.
- Rough period of Congress–League working unanimity after the Pact is often keyed **1916–1922**, until Non-Cooperation politics pulled them apart.
- Do **not** place it at the 1911 Delhi Durbar. Do not confuse it with the Home Rule Leagues, which are separate wartime organisations founded a few months earlier in **1916**.

> **Logic:** Lucknow Pact = **December 1916**, Congress–League reunion + separate electorates + weightage. Not 1911. Not a Home Rule league.

12.3 Montagu Declaration (20 August 1917)

Who:Edwin Montagu, Secretary of State for India **Statement made:** in the **House of Commons**, 20 August 1917

- The Declaration announced that British policy aimed at the **"increasing association of Indians in every branch of the administration"** and the **gradual development of self-governing institutions**, with a view to the **progressive realisation of responsible government in India as an integral part of the British Empire**.
- It was Britain's first formal admission that **responsible government**, not merely welfare administration, was the eventual goal for India.
- It came under direct pressure from the **Home Rule agitation** and from the joint Congress–League demand carried by the **Lucknow Pact**.
- Montagu himself toured India after the Declaration; his talks with Indian leaders and the Viceroy fed into the **Montagu–Chelmsford Reforms**, enacted as the **Government of India Act, 1919**.
- The Declaration is a **statement of intent**, not a reform itself. The actual dyarchy scheme came two years later in **1919**.
- Extremists read it as a vindication of Home Rule pressure; Moderates read it as proof that constitutional agitation still worked.
- Do not confuse this **1917** promise with the **1929 Irwin (इरविन) Declaration** (dominion status (डोमिनियन) as the goal) or the **1940 August Offer** (Linlithgow (लिनलिथगो)'s wartime proposal).

> **Logic:** Montagu Declaration = **20 August 1917**, statement of intent. GoI Act **1919** is the actual reform that followed it.

12.4 Annie Besant

- She was an Irish Theosophist and an Indian nationalist.
- She was also a **Fabian** socialist in Britain before her full India work.
- She led Theosophy in India. She did **not** found the Theosophical Society.
- **H.P. Blavatsky** and **H.S. Olcott** founded it in **New York in 1875**.
- The Indian HQ later sat at **Adyar**.
- Her papers were ***New India*** and ***Commonweal***. They carried Home Rule propaganda.
- She founded **Central Hindu College, Varanasi, in 1898**. It later became the educational nucleus of **BHU**.
- Founded the **All India Home Rule League, September 1916**, Madras/Adyar.
- She was interned in **June 1917**.

- She was **INC President in December 1917**, the first woman to hold the post.
- She later **opposed Gandhi's Non-Cooperation** methods. Do not make her a NCM (असहयोग) lieutenant.

> **Logic:** Besant ≠ Blavatsky. Besant = Home Rule 1916 + Congress President 1917 + Central Hindu College.

12.5 B.G. Tilak (Home Rule phase)

- This card is **Home Rule only**.
- After Mandalay he returned and launched the **Indian Home Rule League** in **April 1916** at **Poona**.
- **Joseph Baptista** was League **President**.
- **N.C. Kelkar** was **Secretary**.
- Baptista is **not** the ILO 1919 labour representative. That is **N.M. Joshi**.
- His famous line is **"Swaraj (स्वराज) is my birthright and I shall have it."**
- **Bal Gangadhar Tilak** (बाल गंगाधर तिलक) **never presided** over an INC session.
- He died on **1 August 1920**, before Non-Cooperation's peak.

> **Logic:** Tilak Home Rule = **April 1916 Poona**. Never Congress President.

12.6 National Education

- The Swadeshi **National Council of Education (August 1906)** and Bengal National College belong with the Swadeshi card.
- **Aurobindo** (अरविंद) was principal of Bengal National College.
- Home Rule years used **lectures, pamphlets and the press** as political education.
- Besant's leagues were an educative machine.
- **Central Hindu College (1898)** grew into **BHU (1916)**. That is the national-education fact of this topic.
- The **Non-Cooperation years (1920–21)** produced a second wave of "national" universities built by boycotting government grants and government-affiliated colleges.
- **Gujarat Vidyapith**, Ahmedabad, was founded in **October 1920** with Gandhi as its first chancellor.
- **Kashi Vidyapith**, Varanasi, was founded in **1921** as a national university free of government control, in the same Non-Cooperation spirit as the 1906 NCE colleges but a full political generation later.
- **Jamia Millia Islamia** began at **Aligarh (अलीगढ़) in 1920**, founded by nationalist Muslims who broke with the government-aided Aligarh college line; it later moved to Delhi in 1925.
- Keep three separate national-education waves in mind: **1906 NCE** (Swadeshi boycott (बहिष्कार) of Curzon (कर्ज़न)'s colleges), **1916 BHU** (Malaviya's cultural-university project, not a boycott), and **1920–21 Vidyapiths/Jamia** (Non-Cooperation boycott of government education).

- **Wardha / Basic Education 1937** and **Sargent 1944** (सार्जेंट) are later education-policy facts, taught in full with the education and press chapter. They are not Home Rule.

> **Logic:** NCE **1906** ≠ BHU **1916** ≠ Vidyapiths/Jamia **1920–21** ≠ Wardha **1937**. Four (चातुर्याम) different waves, four different years.

12.7 BHU Movement

University: Banaras Hindu University, **VaranasiChief organiser (tag):Madan Mohan MalaviyaAct / charter band:1915–16Foundation stone:4 February 1916** (Vasant Panchami) by Viceroy **Lord Hardinge**

- Nationalists wanted a modern university with Indian cultural self-respect, not only government colleges.
- Malaviya raised money from the public, zamindars and princes (Maharaja (महाराज) of **Darbhanga** is a named donor tag).
- **Annie Besant's Central Hindu College (1898)** was folded in as the college nucleus. Besant is a **partner**, not the founder tag.
- Hardinge laid the stone. That is colonial **sanction**, not "Hardinge founded BHU."
- Gandhi gave an early public speech at the 1916 Banaras ceremonies — a chronology glue with his 1915 return, not a BHU-founder claim.
- BHU is a **UP** landmark. It is **not** in Allahabad (इलाहाबाद) or Lucknow. It is **not** the 1906 NCE.

> **Logic:** BHU = **Malaviya + 1916 + Varanasi**. Besant = Central Hindu College link.

12.8 Labour Politics — AITUC and the Party Map

This card's lens is politics, not the full labour chronology. The year-by-year body list (Madras Labour Union, Trade (पण्याध्यक्ष) Unions Act 1926, Girni Kamgar, Meerut (मेरठ) Conspiracy, INTUC, HMS, UTUC, BMS, CITU (सीटू)) is taught in full with the peasant, tribal (आदिवासी) and labour chapter. Here the question is: who ran the labour movement politically, and which later party inherited which trade union.

- The **Whitley (Royal) Commission on Labour (1929–31)** surveyed industrial and plantation labour health, living standards and employer–employee relations — the classic Prelims labour-commission key.
- **N.M. Joshi** carried Indian labour onto the world stage first: he went as **India's labour representative to the ILO conference, Washington, 1919**, a year **before** any all-India trade union body existed.
- **Madras Labour Union (1918)** under **B.P. Wadia** (with V. Kalyanasundaram) is keyed as India's first modern trade union (Buckingham & Carnatic (कर्नाटक) mills).
- Gandhi founded the **Ahmedabad Textile Labour Association** in **1918**.

- **AITUC** was founded on **31 October 1920** at Bombay, and its first president was **Lala Lajpat Rai** — a leading Congress **Extremist**, not a professional labour man. That choice shows how tightly labour organising and nationalist politics were fused at birth.
- **Joseph Baptista** (Tilak's Home Rule League President) and **N.M. Joshi** both sat in AITUC's early leadership, again linking Home Rule politics to the new labour body.
- After independence, the single labour movement **split by party**: the trade-union map became a proxy for party competition.

Trade union	Party in the UPPCS map
AITUC	**CPI**
INTUC (1947)	**Indian National Congress**
UTUC (1949)	**CPI(M)** in the UPPCS pairing (historically RSP; the real CPI(M) centre is **CITU, 1970**)
BMS (1955, Dattopant Thengadi)	**BJP / RSS**

- **N.M. Joshi** was India's labour representative at the **1919** ILO Washington summit, not Wadia, Andrews or Baptista.
- Post-independence union–party pairs: **BMS–BJP; INTUC–Congress; UTUC–CPI(M); AITUC–CPI**.
- AITUC is the syllabus **Trade Union Congress**. INTUC is **1947**, not 1920.

> **Logic:** Joshi = **ILO 1919**. AITUC = **1920, Lajpat Rai**. INTUC = **1947**. Duplicate matching with the peasant-labour chapter is allowed.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS Prelims 2020, Q16)**: N.M. Joshi was sent as the representative of Indian labour to the first International Labour Organisation (ILO) Conference in Washington (1919).
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS Prelims 2022, Q123)**: Trade union political alignments — BMS (Bharatiya Mazdoor Sangh) ↔ BJP; INTUC ↔ Congress; UTUC ↔ CPI(M); AITUC ↔ CPI.

12.9 Left Parties

Body	Year / tag
M.N. Roy / émigré communism	early 1920s (Tashkent memory)
Kanpur Conspiracy Case	**1924** — Muzaffar Ahmed, Nalini Gupta (गुप्त), Shaukat Usmani, S.A. Dange; **M.A. Ansari NOT in**
CPI (formal tag)	**1925, Kanpur**
Workers and Peasants Party	provincial mid-1920s; **All-India form clearer December 1928**

Body	Year / tag
Meerut Conspiracy	**1929**
CSP	**1934** (next card)
Forward Bloc (फॉरवर्ड ब्लॉक)	**1939**, Subhas Bose (Topic 14 depth)

- **WPP** tried to work **inside Congress** and make it more revolutionary (क्रांतिकारी) and mass-based.
- Statement 1 often packs “formed in **1927** and given **All-India** form” into one claim — that is false.
- The All-India WPP conference is **December 1928**. Statement 1 is the trap.
- Statement 2 (work within Congress) is true; statement 1 (1927 All-India birth) is false.
- **CPI** is a **separate** communist party.
- **CSP** is socialists **inside Congress**. Do not merge them.
- Kanpur Conspiracy is a **communist** case, not HRA Kakori.
- **M.N. Roy** was the first Indian linked to the **Communist International** (Lenin’s Comintern, **1919**) and is keyed with the **Tashkent** émigré party memory (**October 1920**).
- **Meerut Conspiracy Case (1929–33)** against labour/communist leaders drew world protest (Einstein, H.G. Wells, Harold Laski and others).
- Revolutionary trade-union phase is often dated **1926–39** (Roy, Muzaffar Ahmed, Dange, Usmani circle).
- **M.N. Roy** founded the **Radical Democratic Party (1940)**. **Saumyendra Nath Tagore** founded the **Revolutionary Communist Party of India (1934)** after breaking from CPI.

> **Logic:** WPP All-India form = **December 1928**, not 1927. **M.A. Ansari** was **not** among early AITUC presidents.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2024, Q14

Consider the following statements with reference to the Workers and Peasants Party:

1. The Workers and Peasants Party was formed in 1927 and was given the form of an All India Organisation.
2. The objective of this party was to work within the Congress so that it could be made a more revolution inclined party and an organisation of the common people.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

A. Both 1 and 2

B. Neither 1 nor 2

C. Only 1

D. Only 2

Show answer

Ans: D — All-India form is associated with **December 1928**, not a clean 1927 All-India birth.

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS Prelims 2021, Q86)**: Kanpur Bolshevik Conspiracy Case (1924) accused included M.N. Roy, Muzaffar Ahmad, S.A. Dange, Shaukat Usmani, Nalini Gupta, Singaravelu Chettiar; Dr. M.A. Ansari was NOT associated.

12.10 Congress Socialist Party

What it was: a **socialist group inside the Indian National CongressNot:** a split that left Congress, and **not** the CPI

- CDM prisoners talked socialism in **Nasik (नासिक) Jail (1932–33)**.
- **Patna conference, May 1934**, then **Bombay, October 1934**, as an all-India party. It was **not** formed in **January 1934**.
- Leaders included **Acharya Narendra Dev**, the UP ideologue.
- **Jayaprakash Narayan**, **Minoo Masani**, **Ashok Mehta** (अशोक मेहता) and **Ram Manohar Lohia** belong to this socialist stream.
- **Jawaharlal Nehru** (जवाहरलाल नेहरू) sympathised with socialism. He did **not formally join** the CSP.
- Congress Socialist Party was **not** formed in January **1934**, and **Nehru never formally joined** it.
- CSP wanted socialist programmes **through Congress**, not a parallel communist party.

> **Logic:** CSP = **1934 inside Congress**. **Not January**. **Nehru did not join**.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2024, Q131

Consider the following statements with reference to the Congress Socialist Party:

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor (UPPCS Prelims)**: Congress Socialist Party was founded in October/November 1934 (Patna/Bombay), not January 1934; Jawaharlal Nehru never formally joined CSP despite ideological affinity.

12.11 Regional Parties

Justice Party (1916, Madras)

- It was a Non-Brahmin movement in the Madras Presidency (प्रेसीडेंसी).
- The founders' circle included **C. Natesa Mudaliar**, **Dr T.M. Nair** and **P. Theagaraya Chetty**.
- It called Congress a **Brahmin-dominated** body and opposed it on that ground.
- It claimed for non-Brahmins the same kind of **communal representation** that **Morley–Minto (1909)** had given to Muslims.
- Both statements about early communist/labour history (इतिहास) can be correct when read separately.

- Later this stream feeds **Periyar** (पेरियार), Self-Respect, and Dravidian parties.
- Periyar left Congress in **1925** and developed the Self-Respect Movement (स्वाभिमान आंदोलन).

> **Logic:** Justice Party formed in **1916 at Madras**.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2024, Q13

Consider the following statements with reference to the Justice Party:

1. The Justice Party opposed Congress by calling it a Brahmin dominated organisation.
2. It claimed the same communal representation for non-Brahmins as the Morley-Minto (मॉर्ले-मिंटो) reforms had given to Muslims.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

A. Both 1 and 2

B. Neither 1 nor 2

C. Only 1

D. Only 2

Show answer

Ans: A

Other regional tags (one line each)

- The **Akali / SGPC** stream in Punjab began as Gurdwara reform and later fed Akali Dal.
- The **Unionist Party** in Punjab was a landed cross-communal provincial party.
- **Forward Bloc** was founded in **1939** by Subhas Bose.
- The **Self-Respect Movement** is Periyar's work after **1925**.

UP Focus

Fact	Detail
BHU	Varanasi, **1916**, Malaviya
Acharya Narendra Dev	CSP ideologue, UP
Home Rule in UP towns	Besant league branches; not Tilak's Poona HQ
Kashi Vidyapith	Varanasi, **1921**, Non-Cooperation national university

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